

LUNGLESS SALAMANDERS

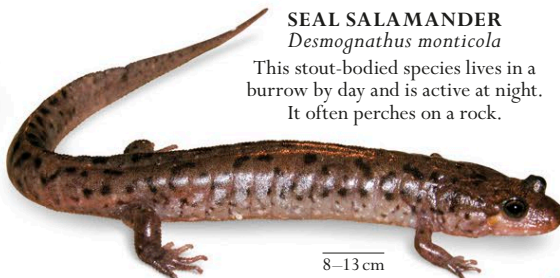
Containing over 390 species, the Plethodontidae are the largest salamander family. Members of this family have no lungs, but breathe through their mouth and skin. Apart from six European species, all live in North, Central, and South America, inhabiting a wide variety of habitats and feeding mainly on small invertebrates.



**MOUNTAIN
DUSKY SALAMANDER**
Desmognathus ochrophaeus

Mostly terrestrial, this salamander is often found foraging in forests in large numbers after heavy rain, and sometimes climbing trees and shrubs.

7–11 cm
2¾–4¼ in



SEAL SALAMANDER
Desmognathus monticola

This stout-bodied species lives in a burrow by day and is active at night. It often perches on a rock.

8–13 cm
3¼–5 in



**ALLEN'S
WORM SALAMANDER**
Oedipina alleni

Found in leaf litter in lowland forests of Costa Rica, this salamander coils up its elongated body and tail when attacked.

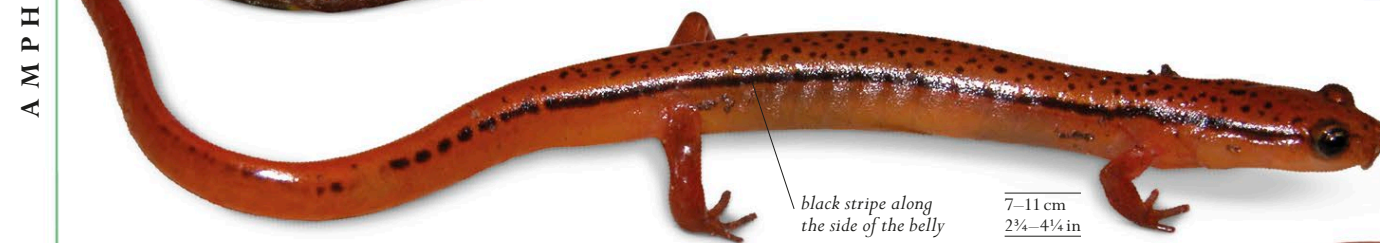
11–15 cm
4¼–6 in



THREE-LINED SALAMANDER
Eurycea guttolineata

Found in and around water, the slender three-lined salamander is a very good swimmer, but spends much of its time in a burrow.

10–16 cm
4–6½ in



**BLUE RIDGE TWO-LINED
SALAMANDER**
Eurycea wilderae

Found around springs and streams, this small species is common in the wooded mountains of the S. Appalachians. It mates in autumn and lays its eggs in winter.

7–11 cm
2¾–4¼ in



MISSISSIPPI SLIMY SALAMANDER
Plethodon mississippi

Found in hardwood forests, this terrestrial salamander protects itself from predators by producing a sticky skin secretion. It lays its eggs on land.

11.5–21 cm
4½–8½ in



RED-BACKED SALAMANDER
Plethodon cinereus

A terrestrial species, this salamander hides under bark by day and hunts for insects and other prey in foliage after dark.

7–12 cm
2¾–4¼ in

GIANT SALAMANDERS

The Cryptobranchidae are three large, wholly aquatic species – one each from Japan, China, and North America. They feed on a wide variety of prey, from worms to small mammals. The family includes the world's largest salamander – the Chinese giant salamander, which is about 1.8 m (6 ft) long.



HELLBENDER
Cryptobranchus alleganiensis
This N. American species has a flattened head that helps it to dig a burrow under rocks, where the males guard the eggs. It has very wrinkled skin.

flattened body

splayed legs

1–1.4 m
3¼–4½ ft



30–75 cm
12–30 in

**JAPANESE
GIANT SALAMANDER**
Andrias japonicus

This aquatic species is threatened by degradation of its habitat. Some males, called “den masters”, defend burrows in which females lay eggs.